

# AI Sales Workflow Decision Matrix

Decide what AI may automate, what a seller must supervise, and what must remain human.

**Rule: AI can accelerate pattern work. It cannot own the truth of a claim, the ethics of a decision, buyer consent, negotiation judgment, or the relationship.**

| Sales task       | AUTOMATE                                                      | SUPERVISE                                                 | HUMAN ONLY                                                        |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Account research | Organize approved public information and deduplicate records. | Review summaries, dates, sources, and missing context.    | Decide fit, relevance, and whether outreach is appropriate.       |
| Signal detection | Monitor approved sources and surface possible changes.        | Verify the event and its timing.                          | Choose whether the signal creates a credible reason now.          |
| Email drafting   | Generate practice variations or a first draft.                | Edit specificity, tone, brevity, proof, and CTA.          | Approve and send; manage replies and opt-outs.                    |
| Call preparation | Create a fictional role-play buyer and question options.      | Check assumptions and customize the practice scenario.    | Listen, adapt, and respond in the live conversation.              |
| Discovery notes  | Transcribe approved recordings and format notes.              | Correct facts, speakers, commitments, and missing nuance. | Qualify, interpret politics, and agree on next steps.             |
| Pipeline math    | Calculate from seller-provided inputs.                        | Confirm definitions, periods, and source data.            | Decide which deals are truly qualified and what action follows.   |
| Cost of inaction | Calculate buyer-approved assumptions.                         | Check units, time period, and double counting.            | Ask permission, interpret impact, and avoid manufactured urgency. |
| Negotiation      | Summarize approved positions and rehearse scenarios.          | Review risks and policy constraints.                      | Make concessions, commitments, and relationship decisions.        |

**VSA-original:** This three-lane classification and the GIFT review are VSA workflow controls. **External validation:** HubSpot distinguishes AI-led data collection from human strategic context and recommends human review controls.

Source: <https://blog.hubspot.com/sales/ai-vs-traditional-prospecting>

# GIFT: the pre-send AI quality gate

Run every AI-assisted message, note, or recommendation through four checks.

| Check            | Pass question                                                                          |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| G - Grounded     | Can every material claim be traced to an approved source, conversation, or CRM record? |
| I - Individual   | Does the output reflect this buyer, account, role, and moment?                         |
| F - Fact-checked | Were names, dates, numbers, integrations, links, and proof verified?                   |
| T - Tone-matched | Does it sound like the seller who will continue the relationship?                      |

## Stop signs

| Stop sign               | Seller action                                                                                       |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Confidential data       | Do not paste customer, employer, personal, contract, pricing, or call data into an unapproved tool. |
| Invented facts          | Do not use unsourced pains, initiatives, metrics, quotes, technologies, or relationships.           |
| Autonomous spam         | Do not allow scale to remove relevance, review, consent, or opt-out handling.                       |
| High-stakes commitments | Do not let AI make pricing, legal, security, product, or contractual promises.                      |
| Biased scoring          | Audit whether recommendations unfairly exclude or favor people or accounts.                         |

# Prompt Lab 1: discovery preparation

Use only approved, verified public or employer-provided information.

**ROLE:** Act as a sales practice coach, not a source of truth.

**CONTEXT:** Company: [name]. Buyer role: [title]. Verified sources: [paste approved excerpts and URLs].

**TASK:**

1. Separate observed facts from possible implications.
2. Suggest three questions that test the implications without assuming they are true.
3. Flag every statement that requires seller verification.
4. Do not invent company initiatives, technologies, people, metrics, or pain.

**OUTPUT:** Fact | Possible implication | Neutral validation question | Verification needed.

## Prompt Lab 2: objection role play

**ROLE:** Play a realistic buyer for a low-stakes sales practice session.

**SCENARIO:** Buyer role: [title]. Seller offer: [one sentence]. Objection: [already have a vendor / send information / not interested / next quarter].

**RULES:** Reveal information only when the seller asks a relevant question. Do not become friendly too quickly. After five exchanges, stop the role play.

**FEEDBACK:** Score the seller on pause, acknowledgement, clarification, relevance, pressure, and next-step quality. Quote the seller's words as evidence.

# Prompt Lab 3: cold email review

Use this after you draft the message yourself.

**INPUTS:** Buyer role, verified signal + URL/date, seller draft, approved proof.

- TASK:**
- 1. Identify unsupported or overconfident claims.
  - 2. Score the draft against the VSA 10-point Cold Email Diagnostic.
  - 3. Recommend the three smallest changes with the greatest buyer impact.
  - 4. Produce one revised version while preserving verified facts.
  - 5. List every fact the seller must confirm before sending.

## Daily AI decision log

| Field                 | Record                            |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Task                  | _____                             |
| Lane selected         | Automate / Supervise / Human only |
| Data used             | _____                             |
| Facts verified        | _____                             |
| Seller judgment added | _____                             |
| Final owner           | _____                             |

**Next step:** Continue with the AI Sales Workflow Pack or practice the objection prompts in the VSM AI Role-Play Lab.